RABBIT

Oryctolagus cuniculus · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Common in the wild · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: Worldwide — grasslands, meadows, and woodland edges

Senses: Its large ears can turn in different directions to pick up sounds.

Signals: It thumps its back feet hard on the ground to warn others of danger.

Watch for: It freezes when it first senses something unusual nearby.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

- Quiet voices — they hear you before you see them.
- No tapping the glass or barriers.
- No flash photography.
- Stand back if the animal moves toward the back — they're telling you something.

If something looks off → tell a keeper.
If you're unsure → Pause · Ask · Escalate.

3-SECOND CHECK BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

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EXHIBIT ENTRY · WALK-BY

HOUSTON INTERACTIVE AQUARIUM & ANIMAL PRESERVE

PATAGONIAN MARA

Dolichotis patagonum · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Near Threatened · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: Argentina — open grasslands and scrublands of Patagonia

Senses: Its large eyes sit high on its head for a wide view.

Signals: It bounds away in high leaps to signal speed and strength to a predator.

Watch for: It can run at very high speed in short bursts to escape predators.

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BENNETT'S WALLABY

Macropus rufogriseus · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Common in the wild · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: Australia and Tasmania — eucalypt forests and coastal heath

Senses: Its large ears can swivel independently to listen in two directions at once.

Signals: It thumps its hind foot loudly on the ground to warn nearby wallabies.

Watch for: It rests quietly in dense cover during the middle of the day.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

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ALPACA

Vicugna pacos · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Domesticated; wild ancestor (vicuña) is near threatened · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: Andes Mountains of South America — high grasslands and farms

Senses: Its large ears stand upright and turn toward new sounds.

Signals: It hums quietly to communicate with herd members while grazing.

Watch for: When alarmed, the whole herd groups tightly together.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

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MONKEY-TAILED SKINK

Corucia zebrata · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Vulnerable · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: Solomon Islands — tropical forest canopy

Senses: Its flickering tongue picks up chemical particles from the air and surfaces.

Signals: It hisses sharply as a warning when it feels threatened.

Watch for: When threatened, it grips tighter with its tail and presses close to the branch.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

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GEOFFROY'S SPIDER MONKEY

Ateles geoffroyi · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Endangered · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: Central and South America — tropical rainforest canopy

Senses: Its eyes face forward, giving it sharp depth perception for jumping between trees.

Signals: It barks as an alarm call when it spots a predator like an eagle.

Watch for: It moves quickly to higher branches away from any ground disturbance.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

- Quiet voices — they hear you before you see them.
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SAILFIN DRAGON

Hydrosaurus pustulatus · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Vulnerable · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: Philippines — rivers, mangroves, and forested riverbanks

Senses: A small third eye on its head senses changes in light level.

Signals: Males raise their large sail-like dorsal crest to signal dominance to other males.

Watch for: When a predator approaches, it drops from its branch directly into the water.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

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NINE-BANDED ARMADILLO

Dasypus novemcinctus · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Least concern · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: North, Central, and South America — grasslands, forest edges, and scrubland

Senses: It smells insects living up to 20 centimeters below the soil surface.

Signals: Mating pairs make a soft chucking sound to communicate with each other.

Watch for: When startled, it can jump straight up into the air before running.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

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SULCATA TORTOISE

Centrochelys sulcata · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Endangered · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: Sahel region of Africa — arid grassland and savanna south of the Sahara

Senses: Its sense of smell guides it to dry grasses and fibrous plants.

Signals: Males produce a loud, resonant call during the mating season.

Watch for: During peak heat, it retreats into its burrow and stays underground.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

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TOCO TOUCAN

Ramphastos toco · Animals are TEACHERS, not attractions.

Least concern · Manager on duty has final say.

WHO YOU'RE MEETING

Lives: South America — forest edges, open woodland, and savanna

Senses: Its long bill reaches fruit at branch tips too thin to climb.

Signals: It produces a deep, repeated croaking call that carries through the forest.

Watch for: It flies in a quick, undulating path when alarmed.

HOW TO BE A GOOD GUEST

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